



Information Classification and Handling Policy



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Document Information

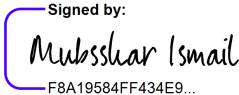
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1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to establish a framework for classifying and handling IBEX information assets based on their sensitivity, value, and criticality. The goal is to ensure appropriate protection throughout the information lifecycle – from creation to secure disposal – and to ensure compliance with applicable legal, regulatory, contractual obligations and client-specific requirements.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all information assets owned by or managed on behalf of IBEX, regardless of format (digital or physical), storage location, or the system used to process it. It is also applicable to all employees and external parties who access, process, or manage IBEX data.

3. Roles and Responsibilities

Role / Team	Description/ Responsibility
Information Owner/ Department Heads	- Determining classification levels for each information asset under their ownership - Maintaining the accuracy, completeness and integrity of information - Authorizing access based on business needs - Regularly reviewing information classifications to align with business needs - Communicating the classification to IT teams and Users
IT Teams	- Implementing and maintaining the required technical controls - Implementing secure disposal methods for classified data
IT Security	- Developing, maintaining, and providing support for the policy itself - Providing guidance and advice on information classification and handling requirements/ best practices
Compliance & Risk Management	- Conducting security awareness training for all employees regarding information classification - Monitoring compliance with the policy
All Users	- Understanding and complying with the policy and all related information handling requirements - Reporting any suspected data mishandling, security incidents, or policy violations immediately - Using information only for authorized business purposes

4. Policy

- 1) Every information asset must have a designated owner.
- 2) The information owner shall be responsible for classifying and defining access rights for each information asset under their ownership.
- 3) The details around information assets shall be recorded in the **Asset Register**.
- 4) Against each asset, the asset register must record following information at the minimum:
 - a. Information Asset name
 - b. Information Asset Type
 - c. Information Asset Description
 - d. Information Asset location
 - e. Information Asset owner
 - f. Information Classification, i.e., whether the information is classified as 'S', 'O', "C", 'I' or 'P'
- 5) The Information Asset Owner shall conduct a review of the 'Asset Register' at least annually to ensure its currency, accuracy and effectiveness.

4.1. Classification Levels

Information assets shall be classified under the following five categories:

- 1) **"PUBLIC"** (P) classification for all information freely available to the public e.g., press releases and IBEX advertising (once approved for issuance), information on public portions of IBEX websites.
- 2) **"INTERNAL"** (I) classification for all information available to IBEX employees and approved non-employees, but not to be disclosed to the public e.g., IBEX policies, procedures, forms and templates.
- 3) **"OPERATIONAL"** (O) classification for all statistical information generated by the company related to contact centre operations and reporting that are supplied to clients and IBEX employees, but not to be disclosed to the public. This classification excludes any data that is supplied by the companies' clients or that may contain information that is personally identifiable e.g., statistical data, daily operational reports.
- 4) **"SECRET"** (S) classification for all information that need to be strictly restricted on a need-to-know basis e.g., sensitive information (CHD/ PII/ PHI), employee data, financial data.
- 5) **"CLIENT"** (C) classification for all information that is owned by clients of IBEX or generated by call activity on their behalf.

5. Information Handling Requirements

The following chart provides the direction on how to handle each classification of information assets.

Classification	Labeling	Access	Storage	Transmission	Disposal	Unauthorized Disclosure Impact
PUBLIC	None	Unrestricted	No requirements	No requirements	No requirements	No harm
INTERNAL	"INTERNAL"	IBEX staff & approved external users as per contract	Secure internal locations	Internal – Plain text External – Plain text w/ IBEX disclaimer / sealed envelop	Cross-cut shredder / deletion	Minimal harm
OPERATIONAL	"OPERATIONAL"	IBEX staff & respective vendors/ clients as per contracts	Secure internal locations	Internal – Plain text External – Plain text w/ IBEX disclaimer / sealed envelop	Cross-cut shredder / deletion	Minimal harm
SECRET	"SECRET"	Need-to-know only; NDA required for external users' access	Secure physical storage / Sensitive or confidential information must be encrypted in electronic form	Restricted; Must use approved encryption methods	Secure wiping	Significant harm
CLIENT	"CLIENT"	Need-to-know only as per the contract with respective clients	No physical storage / Must use approved encryption methods	Restricted; Must use approved encryption methods	Secure wiping	Significant harm

6. Enforcement

Any employee found to have violated this policy may be subject to disciplinary action.

7. Definitions and Abbreviations

Term / Abbreviation	Definition
Information Asset	Any data, document, record, or dataset in physical or electronic format that has value to IBEX and requires protection.
Information Owner	The individual or department responsible for managing, classifying, and granting access to a specific information asset.
PII (Personally Identifiable Information)	Any information that can be used to identify an individual, such as name, address, social security number, or email address.
NDA (Non-Disclosure Agreement)	A legal contract that ensures confidentiality of information shared between parties.
Encryption	The process of converting information into a secure format to prevent unauthorized access, typically using cryptographic algorithms.
Data Classification	The process of categorizing data based on sensitivity and the impact of unauthorized disclosure.
Disposal	The process of securely removing data from storage media to prevent data recovery, including degaussing, overwriting, or physical destruction.
Need-to-Know Basis	A principle by which access to information is granted only if it is necessary for the individual's role or task.
Asset Register	A centralized repository or system for recording key details about IBEX's information assets, including classification and ownership.

8. Revision History

Version	Date	Details of Changes	Change By	Reviewed By	Approved By
1.0	6/25/2025	Initial Document	Sidra Maryam	Muhammad Shahzad Sandra Fernandez	Mubsshar Ismail